

ATTRACTION: Vikramshila University Ruins

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Vikramashila

LOCATION:

Bhagalpur (Antichak village)

DISTRICT / REGION:

Bhagalpur

CATEGORY:

Historical Site / Heritage Site

OVERVIEW:

Vikramshila University Ruins represent one of the three most important Buddhist monasteries in India during the Pala Empire, alongside Nalanda and Odantapuri. Located in present-day Antichak village in the Bhagalpur district, it stands as a testament to India's ancient educational and architectural grandeur.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Vikramashila was a prominent center of learning and a major Buddhist monastery. The ruins, now situated in Antichak village, reflect the vast scale and importance of the institution during ancient times. It was established by the Pala emperor Dharmapala to serve as a high-quality center for scholarship. The site features extensive architectural remains from its historical past.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

Vikramashila was established by the Pala emperor Dharmapala (783 to 820 AD) in response to a supposed decline in the quality of scholarship at Nalanda. It flourished as a major center of Buddhist learning until it was destroyed by the forces of Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khalji around 1193.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

Not Mentioned

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- One of the three most important Buddhist monasteries during the Pala Empire.
- Established by Pala emperor Dharmapala (783 to 820 AD).
- Destroyed by Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khalji around 1193.
- Significant archaeological remains in Antichak village.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit: October to March

Opening Hours: 09:00AM - 05:00PM

Entry Fee: Rs. 25 (Indian), Rs. 300 (Foreigners)

Duration Recommended: Not Mentioned

Photography: Videography & Photography Allowed

Accessibility Information: Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Parking, Restaurants, Drinking Water, Souvenir Shop

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport: Patna

Distance From Airport: 232 Kms

Nearest Railway Station: Kahalgaon

Distance From Railway Station: 07 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand: Kahalgaon

Distance From Bus Stand: 07 Kms

Road Connectivity: Not Mentioned

Nearest Tourist Information Centre: Tourist Information Centre, Bhagalpur combined Building Bhagalpur (40 Kms)

Nearest Police Station: Antichak (02 Km), Ph: 0641-2500601

Nearest Medical Facility: J.L.N. Medical Collage & Hospital, Ph: 0641-2409555; Bhagalpur Sadar Hospital, Ph: 0641-2300837

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

Not Mentioned

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Souvenir Shop available

ACCOMMODATION:

- Hotel President
- Hotel Rajhans International
- Hotel Vaibhav
- Hotel Galaxy 16
- Hotel Panchvati

HOTELS:

- Hotel President
- Hotel Rajhans International (Ph: 0641-2409411)
- Hotel Vaibhav (Ph: 0641-2401111)
- Hotel Galaxy 16 (Mob: 9771471955)
- Hotel Panchvati (Mob: 7549822228)

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Randhir Kumar Jha (Mob: 8709540533)
- Prabhat Kumar Jha (Mob: 8092886910)

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Subh Yatra Travels (Mob: 7903732641)
- Meri Tour and Travel (Mob: 9873838917)
- Nayan Taxi services (Mob: 8676855914)
- Cab Service

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- Built in response to the decline of Nalanda.

- Destroyed in the late 12th century.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Vikramshila University Ruins, located in Antichak village, Bhagalpur, was a major Buddhist monastery and center of learning during the Pala Empire. Established by Emperor Dharmapala between 783 and 820 AD, it rivaled Nalanda and Odantapuri before being destroyed by Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khalji around 1193. The site is open to visitors from 09:00AM to 05:00PM, with an entry fee of Rs. 25 for Indians and Rs. 300 for foreigners.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is Vikramshila University known for?

A: It was one of the three most important Buddhist monasteries in India during the Pala Empire, established by Emperor Dharmapala as a center of high-quality scholarship.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located in Antichak village in the Bhagalpur district of Bihar.

Q: Who destroyed Vikramshila University?

A: It was destroyed by the forces of Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khalji around 1193.

Q: What is the entry fee?

A: Rs. 25 for Indians and Rs. 300 for foreigners.

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: The nearest airport is Patna (232 Kms), and the nearest railway station and bus stand are at Kahalgaon (07 Kms).

KEYWORDS:

Vikramshila University Ruins, Vikramashila, Antichak, Bhagalpur, Pala Empire, Dharmapala, Buddhist monastery, Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khalji, ancient education, Bihar heritage.